Activity 05 - Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics

Course: Mastering The Art of Conflict Resolution to Foster Team Collaboration and Success (TGS-2023021752) Duration: 60 minutes Materials: Negotiation canvas | option scorecard Output: An interest-based negotiation canvas, option scorecard and written service-allocation agreement.

Objective

Negotiate workload and service priorities using interests, options and objective criteria.

Psychological-safety boundary

Use only the fictional case. Do not require anyone to disclose a personal conflict. Any participant may call a pause or request another role. This learning activity does not replace organisational policy, HR advice or legal advice.

Scenario

CarePoint Clinics must cover three Saturday vaccination sessions during a seasonal surge. Nurse lead Mei wants two extra staff at each session; operations lead Arjun says the overtime ceiling permits only one. Both need safe patient care and sustainable staffing. Each receives private interests and tradeable options, then negotiates a package using demand data, skill coverage, overtime limits and rotation history.

Detailed instructions

Role cards

Give each participant only their own role before the first round. Observers use the checklist.

Mei | Nurse Lead

Goal: protect patient safety and staff recovery. Private brief: Can trade session length and skill mix but not minimum clinical coverage.

Arjun | Operations Lead

Goal: stay within approved cost and service commitments. Private brief: Can reallocate hours and seek conditional approval with evidence.

Observer | Process Coach

Goal: test fairness and process quality. Private brief: Tracks questions, summaries, criteria, options and closing clarity.

1. Prepare separately. Each role identifies its position, underlying interests, evidence, constraints, preferred outcome, walk-away boundary and alternatives if no agreement is reached.

2. Set a shared problem statement. Convert the dispute into a joint question about meeting patient demand, staff capacity and service quality.

3. Exchange interests. Each side explains interests and constraints while the other paraphrases before responding.

4. Agree objective criteria. Select criteria such as patient risk, demand forecast, staffing capability, cost, equity and implementation time.

5. Generate packages. Create at least three multi-variable options rather than arguing about a single fixed allocation.

6. Score options. Rate each package against the agreed criteria, show assumptions and note where data is uncertain.

7. Trade across differences. Look for low-cost/high-value exchanges, sequencing, pilots and conditional commitments without trading away policy or safety.

8. Check authority and fairness. Confirm who can commit resources and whether affected staff or patient voices require consultation.

9. Draft the agreement. Record allocation, actions, owners, dates, evidence, communication and a review trigger.

10. Plan no-agreement handling. State the temporary operating rule and escalation route if authority or evidence is insufficient.

11. Debrief process. Identify which questions uncovered interests, which criterion resolved disagreement and what could damage implementation.

Suggested timing

- 7 minutes - Role preparation
- 6 minutes - Shared problem and interests
- 7 minutes - Criteria
- 10 minutes - Option packages
- 8 minutes - Scoring and trade-offs
- 7 minutes - Agreement or escalation
- 5 minutes - Debrief

Discussion questions

- What are each party's positions, interests, constraints and alternatives?
- Which objective criteria should guide a fair rota?
- What package trades across time, skill mix, session design and budget?
- What must be recorded so implementation does not create a new conflict?

Submission

Submit the completed worksheet and checklist. Use role names rather than real personal data, mark unresolved information as unknown and retain the artefact only through the approved course channel.

Debrief

The agreement explains interests, criteria, trade-offs, owners, escalation conditions and review date.